

More on temporal parts

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The problem of temporary intrinsics

- Distinguish three questions:
 - Does it make sense to say that an object is F (e.g. bent / straight / a person / a child) simpliciter, as opposed to at this or that time?
 - Does the claim that an object is F at t entail that that object is F simpliciter?
 - Does the claim that an object is F at t entail that something (that exists at t) is F simpliciter?

- Lewis's trilemma:

1. Relationalism: 'F *simpliciter*' makes no sense at all —so Fness is not really a property at all, but a relation.

2. Presentism: 'F *simpliciter*' does make sense; 'x is F at *t*' means 'x is F *simpliciter* according to *t*'

3. Temporal parts: 'F *simpliciter*' does make sense; 'x is F at *t*' means 'x's *t*-temporal part is F *simpliciter*'

- Is the trilemma exhaustive?
 - Not as far as I can see!
 - Someone might claim that ‘straight simpliciter’ makes sense, but that nothing is actually straight simpliciter.
 - The challenge: surely there must be *some* intimate relation between ‘F simpliciter’ and ‘F at t ’. What else could it be?

- Is Lewis right to think that option 1 means that F-ness is really a relation?
 - A popular response: *property-instantiation is relative to time.*
 - But what about properties like *straight at t* or *straight at some time or other*? These seem to be properties that can be had absolutely, not just at this or that time.

Sider on the arguments against temporal parts

- The view makes things into *events*.
- No *real* change in the world, if there are temporal parts?
 - The Facts don't change
- A crazy metaphysic — where do all these new things come from?